

MULTI-AGENT MODULE · CONFIGURATION

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Telegram:

Groups, Topics

& Agents

How to organize your Telegram with topics and

configure your AI to respond

automatically in each of them · without

having to tag the bot all the time.

DURATION

~20

min

LEVEL

Intermediate

PRE-

REQUIREMENT

Agent

configured

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01

What are topics?

Understanding the structure before configuring

Imagine a Telegram group as a building. Topics are the floors · each floor has its own conversation, but everyone lives in the same building.

With topics, you can have in the same group:

A topic for the course · where your agent answers students' questions

A technical support topic · without mixing it with the rest

A topic for ideas and projects

A topic for personal use, just for you

· The great advantage is that you can have the same agent behaving differently in each topic · or even use completely separate agents per topic.

02

Creating your group with topics

Step by step from scratch

· Attention: Only supergroups support topics. A normal group does not have this option. The step 3 below automatically transforms your group into a supergroup.

1 Create a new group on Telegram

Menu (·) · New Group · choose the name (ex: Meu HQ) · add at least one person · confirm.

2 Open the group settings

Tap the group name at the top of the screen · pencil icon (edit).

3 Make it a Supergroup

Go to Group Type · set a public @username (ex: @meuhq_2025). The Telegram automatically converts to supergroup.

4 Activate the topics

In the settings · Topics · turn on the toggle. Telegram creates the General topic automatically (ID: 1).

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5 Create your topics

On the group screen · topics icon · "Create Topic" · name + emoji. Each topic will have a unique ID (e.g., 2638).

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03

Adding your agent to the group

Two essential settings before anything else

Step 1 · Turn off Privacy Mode in BotFather

By default, bots only see messages where they are directly tagged (@botname message). For the agent to read everything without needing to be tagged, you need to turn off Privacy Mode:

1 Open @BotFather on Telegram

Type /my-bots · choose your bot · Bot Settings · Group Privacy · Turn off.

2 Confirm that it is off

BotFather will show: "Privacy mode is disabled for [your bot]". Done.

Step 2 · Add as Administrator

1 Add the bot to the group

Group settings · Administrators · Add Administrator · search for the @username of your bot · add.

2 Activate topic permission

On the bot's permissions screen, enable "Manage Topics". Without this, it cannot act within the topics.

· Classic error: Add the bot to the group but forget to make it an admin. Result: it doesn't read messages from topics, only from "General". Always make it an administrator.

04

Discovering the ID of each topic

The easiest way: ask your own AI!

Each topic has a unique ID that you will need for configuration. No terminal needed · just ask your agent:

In a private chat with your agent, send:

"Amora, join group X, send any message in topic Y and tell me what the complete chat ID of that topic is."

It will answer something like: telegram:-1003873964847:topic:2638

Write down the ID of each topic you want to configure. You will need them in the next step.

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Configuring how the agent responds

Defining in which topics it speaks freely and in which only when called

There are two activation modes:

mention · the agent only responds when someone types @botname message

all · the agent responds to any message in the topic, even without being tagged

You define this per topic in your config.yaml :

· Careful with the Chat ID: always use the ID with :topic:XXXX at the end. If you only use the ID of the group (telegram:-1003873964847 without the topic), the agent will respond in all group topics.

After editing the config, restart the gateway for the changes to take effect:

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agents:

- id: amora-main

model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6

workspaceDir: /root/.openclaw/workspace-amora

activation:

surfaces:

- surface: telegram

mode: mention # default: only when tagged

overrides:

"Course" topic · responds to everything, without needing to tag

- chat: "telegram:-1003873964847:topic:2638"

mode: all

"Support" topic · also responds to everything

- chat: "telegram:-1003873964847:topic:2640"

mode: all

"General" topic · only when tagged

- chat: "telegram:-1003873964847:topic:1"

mode: mention

YAML

openclaw gateway restart

BASH

·Testing: send a message in a topic configured with mode: all without tagging the bot. If it replies, it worked!

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06

One agent or several?

The most important decision when working with multiple topics

When you have multiple topics, you need to decide: does a single agent respond in all of them, or does each topic have its own agent?

- One agent for everything

(Shared MAIN)

- 1 shared workspace

- Remembers everything from all topics

- 1 set of crons and heartbeats

- Cheaper (1 process)

- Simple setup

- One agent per topic

(Isolated agents)

- Workspace separated by agent

- Context isolated by topic

- Independent crons

- More expensive (N processes)

- More complex setup

- ONE AGENT · ADVANTAGES

- Cross memory ("remember that idea from the other topic?")

- Quick setup · 1 config, 1 workspace

- 1 heartbeat does everything

- Economical

- ONE AGENT · RISKS

- Context from different topics gets mixed up

- No privacy between topics

- Context grows very quickly

- ISOLATED AGENTS ·

ADVANTAGES

- Total privacy (topic A doesn't leak into B)

- Different SOUL.md per topic

- Different model per topic (Haiku in support, Opus in dev)

- Clean and focused context

- ISOLATED AGENTS · RISKS

- Agents don't "remember" other topics

- Multiple crons and heartbeats to maintain

- More initial configuration

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Recommendation for those who are starting: start with a single agent. It's simpler, works very well for personal use, and you can migrate to isolated agents when you feel the real need.

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07

Which architecture is for me?

Real scenarios to help you decide

- Use one agent for everything when...

You are the only user of the topics. The topics are your related projects (blog, course, app). You want the agent to remember conversations between topics. You want to keep things simple at the beginning.

- Use isolated agents when...

You have multiple clients and need the data of one to never appear to the other.

You want very different behaviors per topic (teacher in one, technical support in another). You need different models per context to control cost.

- Use hybrid when...

You want a main agent for personal use (private chat with you) and isolated agents for other contexts · such as a topic shared with clients or a community.

08

Configuration Checklist

Before marking as done, confirm these points

Group created and converted to supergroup (has @username)

Topics created with names and emojis

Privacy Mode disabled in BotFather

Bot added as administrator with "Manage Topics" permission

Chat IDs of topics noted

config.yaml updated with topic overrides

openclaw gateway restart executed

Test done: message without mentioning the bot · response received ·

·Final tip: there's no wrong architecture. There's the one that works for your current moment.
Start simple, observe where it hurts, and adjust. That's how everyone learns.

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